

MANUEL AGUIRRE

Frontend Engineer

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SUMMARY

Frontend engineer with a A.A.S. in Web Development and hands-on experience building full-stack React applications. Comfortable with TypeScript, REST APIs, auth systems, real-time streaming, and cloud deployment. Strong instinct for component architecture and engineering reasoning — focused on writing maintainable code that solves real problems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend: React, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Next.js, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, React Router, Vite

Backend: Node.js, Express.js, REST APIs, SSE streaming, Supabase (PostgreSQL)

Auth & Infra: Clerk, Upstash (rate limiting), Vercel, Railway, Netlify

Tools: Git, GitHub, Postman, Zed, VS Code

PROJECTS

Gorilla AI — AI Learning Platform | *React · TypeScript · Supabase · Clerk · OpenRouter API*

[Live → manuelaguirre.dev/projects/gorilla-ai](https://manuelaguirre.dev/projects/gorilla-ai)

- Architected a custom useReducer/chatReducer state machine handling chat sessions, message streaming, loading states, and conversation persistence — avoiding prop drilling across a complex component tree
- Implemented real-time AI response streaming using Server-Sent Events (SSE) with AbortController for cancellation, wired to OpenRouter's API with Claude Sonnet hardcoded as the model
- Designed a Supabase schema with conversations and messages tables; wired Clerk auth so all data is scoped per user with zero leakage
- Built Upstash-based rate limiting on the API route to prevent abuse without blocking legitimate usage
- Deployed on Vercel to start using today here at <https://gorilla-ai-theta.vercel.app/>

Recipe App — Full-Stack Search Application | *React · TypeScript · Node.js · Express · Spoonacular API*

[Live → manuelaguirre.dev/projects/recipe-app](https://manuelaguirre.dev/projects/recipe-app)

- Built an Express backend proxy to route all Spoonacular API requests server-side — protecting the API key and preventing direct client exposure
- Designed a responsive React/TypeScript frontend with search, filtering, and recipe detail views; deployed frontend on Vercel and backend on Railway
- Chose a separate backend architecture deliberately to simulate production separation of concerns rather than calling the third-party API directly from the client

EDUCATION

A.A.S. in Web Development

Des Moines Area Community College (DMACC) · *Graduated 2025*